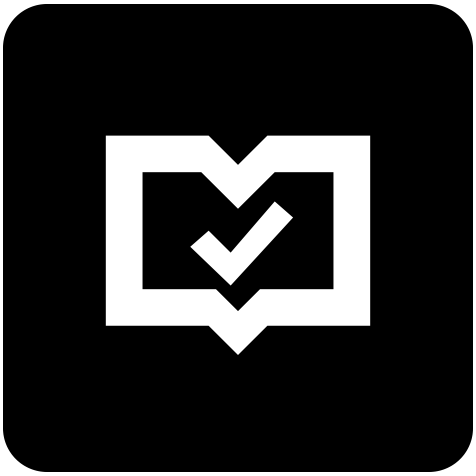


BASEBALL · BOYS AND MEN · GRADES 9 TO 12 · SPORT PLAYBOOK

MEN'S BASEBALL: THE WHOLE ROAD TO COLLEGE

What to do, when to do it, who pays, and what a coach is and is not allowed to tell you. Built from the 2026-27 NCAA rule text, the printed Division I recruiting calendar, the NAIA and junior college rule books, and the 2026 draft results.

VERSION	RULES CHECKED	LEVELS COVERED
2026-27 · sample player: class of 2029	11 November 2026, against the NCAA rule text, the printed Division I calendar, the NAIA handbook and the NJCAA signing chart	D1 · D2 · D3 · NAIA · junior college

> NCAA baseball fields 940 teams across three divisions, and 127 high school seniors were picked in the 2026 draft out of the 472,598 who played in the latest counted high school year. Many families pay for exposure before they learn the two things a staff actually uses. Those two are a schedule of events a coach can watch, and the dates he is allowed to answer.

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This is education. It is not legal advice or school advice. It promises no result, no playing time, no acceptance, and no money. The NCAA Eligibility Center makes the final call on school rules, and each school decides its own aid. Dates marked PROJECTED are worked out from the rule text, not printed by the NCAA yet. Chapter 3 lists them.

1. READ THIS FIRST

Read Chapter 2 before you spend any money. Then put the plan in Chapter 3 on one page and cross items off. The rest is for reference: what the rules allow, what to send, what the paper means, and what it costs.

THE MAIN IDEA

The rules are free. The dates are free. Most families never read them. This book read them on 11 November 2026 and wrote down where each one is printed. A family that knows three things is ahead of a family that spends far more. Those three things are the roster number, the dates a coach may answer, and the paper that counts.

This book is written to the parent of a boy in the class of 2029. He is in 10th grade this school year. He is a junior in 2027-28 and a senior in 2028-29. Every date here is his date. If your son is in another class, the rules are the same and the dates are not. Work each date out again from the rule printed next to it.

WHAT MAKES BASEBALL DIFFERENT

Three things move the calendar and the money.

First, baseball waits longer. The general Division I rule for other sports lets a coach call or write from 15 June after 10th grade. In baseball the date is 1 August of junior year. A coach may not meet him off campus, or host him on a visit, until 1 September of junior year.

Second, the number that matters is a roster number, and it is 34. A roster is the list of players on a team. The number many recruiting pages still print is 11.7 scholarships. That number is not in the current rule book. Chapter 2 prints both, with the document for each.

Third, pro ball sits next to college ball. The draft is the yearly event where Major League Baseball teams pick new players. Teams picked 613 players in the 2026 draft. Of those, 127 were high school seniors, 474 came from four-year colleges and 12 came from junior colleges. So college is also the main road to the draft.

THREE RULES THAT SURPRISE FAMILIES

- **He may not phone a Division I coach early.** The rule stops the coach from making a call, and from taking one, before 1 August of junior year. For the class of 2029 that day is 1 August 2027, worked out from the rule. Email and texts from the coach wait for the same day.
- **Division II may write to him at any time.** The date families quote is 15 June before junior year. That date is for meeting in person, paid visits and tryouts. It is not for calls or texts.
- **There is no National Letter of Intent any more.** Division I ended it in October 2024. The paper is now a written offer of athletics aid. He may sign from the second Wednesday in November of 12th grade. For him that day is Wednesday 8 November 2028, worked out from the rule.

WORDS THIS BOOK USES

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
NCAA	The body that sets the rules for most four-year college sports. It has three levels: Division I, Division II and Division III.
NAIA	A second body for four-year colleges. It has its own rules and its own Eligibility Center.
JUNIOR COLLEGE	A two-year college. The NJCAA is the national body this book read. It has three divisions of its own.
BYLAW	One numbered rule in a rule book. This book prints the number so you can look it up.
ROSTER LIMIT	A cap on people, not money. In Division I baseball it is 34 at a school that opted in.
OPTED-IN SCHOOL	House is a court case that changed Division I roster and scholarship rules. An opted-in school is in one of the five conferences named in that case, or it chose the same rules.
EQUIVALENCY	A cap on money that a coach may cut into pieces. One equivalency is worth one full scholarship. Division II baseball has 9.0.
COUNTER	A player who gets athletics aid, so he counts against a limit.
CONTACT	A coach meeting your son or your family in person, away from the college.
EVALUATION	A coach watching him play in person, away from the college.
OFFICIAL VISIT	A campus visit the college pays for. This book also calls it a paid visit.
UNOFFICIAL VISIT	A campus visit your family pays for.
TRYOUT	A workout a college runs to test one player. Division II and NAIA rules allow it, with limits.
TRANSCRIPT	His school's own record of his classes and grades.
ELIGIBILITY CENTER	The NCAA office that decides whether he may play. Its last answer is called a final certification.
REQUEST LIST	The rule book calls it the institutional request list. He must be on a school's list before a paid Division I visit. Ask the coach to add him.
CORE COURSE	A high school class the NCAA counts. Division I asks for 16 core courses.
LETTER OF INTENT	A paper a player signs with one college. The NCAA no longer has one. Junior colleges still do.
SIGNEE	A player who has signed a junior college letter of intent.
AID AGREEMENT	The written offer that took the place of the letter of intent. The rule book calls it an athletics aid agreement.
CLUB	Any team that is not his school team: a travel team, a summer team or a fall team.
SERVICE	A price or number from a seller's own page, not from a rule book.
HARD	A date that a document prints. You can look it up today.
PROJECTED	A date this book worked out from rule text. The NCAA has not printed it yet. Chapter 3 tags every one.

2. HOW MANY PLAYERS A TEAM CAN TAKE

Start here, before you pay for anything. A team can keep only so many players, and it can pay only so many of them. Each level counts in its own way. This table shows the count, the money rule, and where each one is printed.

LEVEL	PROGRAMS	LIMIT ON PLAYERS	LIMIT ON MONEY	WHERE IT IS PRINTED
DIVISION I, OPTED IN	Part of 309	34 on the roster	No NCAA limit. The school may give full or partial aid to any of the 34.	Bylaw 17.2, Division I Manual 2026-27
DIVISION I, NOT OPTED IN	Part of 309	No NCAA roster limit	The aid ceiling from 2024-25, which was 11.7	NCAA settlement questions and answers, updated 29 May 2026
DIVISION II	251	Not read. See Chapter 11.	9.0 equivalencies	Bylaw 15.4.2.1.1, Division II Manual 2026-27
DIVISION III	380	Not read. See Chapter 11.	No athletics aid at all	Bylaw 15.01.3, Division III Manual 2026-27
NAIA	No official count	No roster limit	A ceiling of 12 on the team's school aid	NAIA Official Handbook 2026-2027, printed pages 121 and 123
JUNIOR COLLEGE	397, not settled. See Chapter 5.	30 signees a team	Set by the college's NJCAA division	NJCAA Sports Procedures Chart for 2026-27

Chapter 5 says how each program count was made. Every source was read on 11 November 2026.

TWO DIVISION I NUMBERS, AND THE ONE THAT BINDS

STATUS	THE RULE	THE DOCUMENT THAT CARRIES IT, AND ITS DATE
SUPERSEDED	11.7 scholarships of aid for the whole team. No more than 27 players could share it. Each of the 27 had to get at least 25 percent of a full scholarship.	NCAA Division I Manual 2024-25, Bylaws 15.5.4 and 15.5.4.1. Read 11 November 2026. The rule is not in the 2026-27 manual.
IN FORCE	A roster limit of 34 players, and no NCAA limit on aid. It applies at a school in one of the five conferences named in the House court case, and at any school that opted in.	NCAA Division I Manual 2026-27, Bylaw 17.2, page footer dated 11 November 2026. The College Sports Commission roster table, read 11 November 2026, prints "Old Scholarship Limit 11.7, New Roster Limit 34."

Which one binds your family today? The 34 does. It is the rule in the current manual. The 11.7 is superseded, which means a newer rule took its place. A page that still says "11.7 scholarships" is quoting the 2024-25 rule.

The old number lives on in one place. A Division I school that did not opt in has no NCAA roster limit, and it stays under the 2024-25 aid ceiling. A school that did not opt in may give aid of any size, even less than 25 percent, to any number of players. The 27-player cap and the 25 percent floor are gone. If it gives more than 11.7 scholarships worth, it follows the settlement rules, and that includes the 34 roster limit. The settlement is the deal that closed the House court

case. The NCAA said so in a question-and-answer paper updated 29 May 2026. This book has no list of who opted in. So ask each Division I school one question: did you opt in? If the answer is no, ask how much of the 11.7 the staff uses.

WHAT THE 34 MEANS FOR YOUR SON

- **A small scholarship uses a whole spot.** The Commission says a player with athletics aid "must be included on the sport's submitted roster for the entirety of the academic year." So aid of any size takes one of the 34.
- **The list has a due date.** The roster is due the day before the first game that counts toward the championship, or 1 December, whichever comes first. From the next day, only players on that list may take part. Those are Bylaws 17.2.1 and 17.2.2.
- **"No limit" does not mean a full scholarship.** The Commission says schools "have the option to offer full or partial scholarships to every student-athlete on a team's roster." An option is not a promise. Its table prints 22.3 as the "Potential Increase in Scholarships." That is the most a school could add, not what it will add.
- **Thirty-four spots over four classes is eight or nine a class.** That is this book's arithmetic, not a count of any team. Players also move from one college to another, and this book did not read the baseball transfer rules. So ask how many high school players the staff will add in 2029.

THE OTHER LEVELS, IN PLAIN NUMBERS

Division II: 9.0 for the whole team. The NCAA calls this an equivalency limit. It says coaches "often divide available scholarship funds among multiple players." A partial award counts as a fraction. The top is the athletics aid he gets for food, housing, tuition and fees. The bottom is the value of a full scholarship for him at that school. An award worth half of a full one counts as half. So 9.0 can pay 18 players half each, or 36 players a quarter each. That is this book's arithmetic. There is one more cap. A school may give no more than 60 total awards across all men's sports other than football and basketball. The rules are Bylaws 15.4.2.1.1, 15.4.2.1.1.1 and 15.4.2.2.

Division III: no athletics aid. Bylaw 15.01.3 bars aid based on "athletics leadership, ability, participation or performance." The rule is about aid for sports. Ask the college's aid office what other aid it gives. Division III is also the largest NCAA group, with 380 programs.

NAIA: a ceiling of 12 on aid, and no roster limit. The NAIA Official Handbook 2026-2027 prints "Baseball 12" under the heading "Upper Limits for Institutional Aid." That is printed page 123, which is page 124 of the PDF file. Institutional aid is aid the college itself gives. So the 12 is a ceiling on a team's school aid. It is not a limit on players. Printed page 121 says, "No limit will be placed on the number of student-athletes on any varsity roster." The table prints no unit for the 12. The NAIA's own aid page calls its limits full awards that a school may divide. Read that way, 12 can pay 24 players half each. That is this book's arithmetic.

Junior college: 30 signees a team. A signee is a player who signs the junior college letter of intent. The NJCAA chart for 2026-27 prints 30 for baseball, and says the number is the same in each of its three divisions. The chart also says it is tentative and may change. The chart is reissued during the year, so check the association's own page for the newest file. Each signee counts as one, "regardless of the amount of athletic scholarship." So a small award takes the same spot as a full one.

JUNIOR COLLEGE LEVEL	WHAT THE COLLEGE MAY PAY FOR
NJCAA DIVISION I	Tuition and course fees, room and board, course books, up to $250 in required supplies, and one trip home each school year.
NJCAA DIVISION II	Tuition, course fees, books, and up to $250 in supplies. No travel home.
NJCAA DIVISION III	Nothing. These programs "may not provide any athletic scholarship of any kind."

Source: NJCAA Bylaws for 2026-27, file dated 27 October 2026, page 44. A junior college picks its division sport by sport, not for the whole school. Ask which division its baseball team plays in.

HOW LONG THE ODDS ARE

WHAT WAS COUNTED	NUMBER	WHERE IT IS FROM
High school baseball players, 2024-25	472,598	NCAA Research table, last updated March 2026
NCAA baseball players, all three divisions	41,580	The same table
Share of high school players who play NCAA baseball	8.8 percent	The same table
Share who play in Division I, Division II and Division III	2.7, 2.6 and 3.5 percent	The same table
Players picked in the 2026 draft, over 20 rounds	613	Major League Baseball release, 13 July 2026
High school seniors among the 613	127, or 20.7 percent	A count of the league's own draft data for this book
Of the 127, picked in rounds 1 to 10, counting the six extra rounds	60	The same count
Of the 127, picked in rounds 11 to 20	67	The same count
Picks in the 2025 draft who came from NCAA schools	452 of 615	NCAA Research table, last updated March 2026

The six extra rounds are groups of picks that the league's draft data lists beside rounds 1 to 20. It calls them compensation and competitive-balance rounds. They are why 20 rounds made 613 picks and not 600.

The NCAA share counts NCAA schools only. NAIA and junior college players are left out, so the share who play in college at all is higher. Of the 452 college picks, 431 came from Division I, 19 from Division II and 2 from Division III. Set the 127 next to the 472,598, which counts all four grades. In one draft year, about 1 in 3,700 high school players is picked. Count seniors only and it is about 1 in 930. Both are this book's rough arithmetic. The senior figure assumes one player in four is a senior. The two counts also come from two sources and two years. Being drafted is not the same as signing a pro contract.

FOUR QUESTIONS TO ASK A COACH BEFORE YOU SPEND

1. Did your school opt in to the new Division I rules?
2. How many players do you expect on the roster you turn in?
3. How many high school players will you add in 2029, and how many at his position?
4. If you offer aid, how much is it, and which costs does it cover?

3. THE PLAN BY DATE, CLASS OF 2029

He is in 10th grade this year, so every date below is his. Rows tagged HARD are dates a document prints. Rows tagged PROJECTED are worked out from rule text the NCAA has not printed for his year yet. Check each one again inside six months of the date.

WHEN	WHAT IS HAPPENING	WHAT YOUR FAMILY DOES
PROJECTED AND HARD	HARD means a document prints this date. You can look it up today. PROJECTED means this book worked the date out from the words of a rule. No one has printed it yet, so it can move.	
12 OCT 2026 TO 28 FEB 2027 HARD	Division I quiet period. A coach may meet players only on his own campus. He may not meet or watch anyone off campus. Source: the 2026-27 Division I baseball calendar.	Do not pay for a winter event because a Division I coach is on the flyer. In a quiet period his staff may work only its own camp, on its own campus or regular field. That is Bylaw 13.12.1.2.1.
9 TO 12 NOV 2026 7 TO 10 JAN 2027 HARD	Two Division I dead periods. Nothing happens in person, on campus or off, and there are no visits. Calls and messages go on. The first signing day for this year's seniors is 11 November 2026.	Nothing to do this year. Note that the first dead period sat on signing week. His own signing week is two years away.
24 TO 29 NOV 2026 22 TO 27 DEC 2026 HARD	Two Division I recruiting shutdowns. No recruiting of any form is allowed. That means no visits, no mail, and no calls made or taken.	Learn the word now. When his own years are printed, a quiet phone on a shutdown day is a rule, not a no.
1 MAR TO 31 JUL 2027 HARD	Division I contact period. Staff may go off campus to meet and watch players. Three dead periods cut into it: 31 May to 7 June 2027, 19 to 21 June 2027, and 3 to 5 July 2027.	Put his games on one page and cross out the dead periods. His school season runs on dates your state association sets, and this book prints none of them. Ask each staff what it may do with a 10th grader. Chapter 11 says why.
PROJECTED 1 JUN 2027	A junior college may pay for a visit from 1 June before junior year. It is one paid visit per college each recruiting year, for no more than 48 hours. Source: NJCAA Bylaws, Section 4, B.1.	The college may pay for him and two guests. If a junior college is on his list, ask what the visit covers before you book travel.
PROJECTED 15 JUN 2027	Division II may meet him in person, pay for one visit per school, and hold one tryout per school. Its calls and texts were allowed at any time before this. Division II Bylaws 13.1.1.1, 13.3.1.2 and 13.8.2.1.	Have a transcript ready. Division II needs one before a paid visit. A paid visit there may last no more than 48 hours.
PROJECTED END OF 10TH GRADE	Division III coaches may meet him in person off campus once he has finished his sophomore year. Their calls, email and texts have no start date. Division III Bylaws 13.1.1.1 and 13.02.10.1.	Use his own school's last day. A Division III coach may answer his email today.

WHEN	WHAT IS HAPPENING	WHAT YOUR FAMILY DOES
PROJECTED 1 AUG 2027	The first day a Division I coach may call him, take his call, email him, text him or mail him recruiting material. Bylaws 13.1.3.1.1, 13.1.3.2.3 and 13.4.1.1.	Send the Chapter 6 email that day and ask for a call time. The 2027-28 calendar is not out yet. Check it for a shutdown before you read silence as a no.
PROJECTED 1 SEP 2027	The first day a Division I coach may meet him off campus or pay for a visit. It is also the first day for an unofficial visit with the baseball staff, and for recruiting talk at the school's own camp. A school has seven recruiting chances with him a year. From this day, no more than three off-campus contacts may be among the seven. Bylaws 13.1.1.1.1, 13.6.2.1.2, 13.7.1.2, 13.12.1.5.2 and 13.1.5.2.	Before a paid Division I visit he must do three things. He must send a transcript, register with the Eligibility Center, and be on that school's request list. That is Bylaw 13.6.3. Do all three in August.
PROJECTED 1 JAN 2028	Division III may pay for a visit from January 1 of junior year. It is one paid visit per school, for no more than 48 hours. Unofficial visits were allowed before this. Division III Bylaws 13.6.1.1.1, 13.6.2 and 13.7.1.	If a Division III school has answered him, ask about a paid visit now.
PROJECTED START OF 12TH GRADE	Division I counts 10 of his 16 core courses before his seventh semester, the first half of 12th grade. Seven of the 10 must be English, math or science. Those 10 grades are then locked. Bylaw 14.3.1.1(b).	Count the 10 with his counselor in the spring of 11th grade, while he can still add a class.
PROJECTED 12TH GRADE, 2028-29	The Eligibility Center opens its athletics certification request in senior year. The Center says it will not begin his file until an NCAA school asks for it.	Ask each school that is recruiting him to request his file.
PROJECTED 1 NOV 2028	The first day he could sign a junior college letter of intent, if the 2028-29 chart keeps this year's date of 1 November. He must have finished 11th grade first. Source: NJCAA chart for 2026-27, and NJCAA Bylaws, Section 3, A.2 and A.3.	The letter lasts one school year at most. Once he signs, other NJCAA colleges may not contact him. Sign only with the college he means to attend.
PROJECTED WED 8 NOV 2028	The first day he may sign a written offer of athletics aid with a Division I or Division II school. The rule is the second Wednesday in November, from 7 in the morning in Division I. The NCAA printed this year's date as 11 November 2026, and the 2028-29 sheet is not out. In Division II the 48 hours before the signing hour are a dead period. Bylaws 13.02.13.1(f) and 13.02.10.1(c).	Each school sets its own last day to sign. Ask for that date in writing, and read Chapter 7 before he signs.
PROJECTED BY 1 DEC 2029	At an opted-in Division I school the roster of 34 is due. The rule says the day before the first game that counts toward the championship, or 1 December, whichever is first. Bylaw 17.2.1.	Before he signs, ask in writing whether he will be on that list in his first year.

The Division I baseball calendars for 2027-28 and 2028-29 are not printed yet. Those are his junior and senior years. So this book prints no contact, quiet, dead or shutdown dates for them. Do not reuse this year's dates.

WHAT A MISSED DATE COSTS

A file that is not final keeps him out of games. Without a final certification a player may practice for no more than 45 days, and he may not play. Those are Bylaws 12.1.1.1.3 and 12.1.1.1.3.1. A player with no transcript, no Eligibility Center account, or no place on the request list gets no paid Division I visit. And the 10 core courses are counted before 12th grade starts, then locked.

4. WHAT A COACH MAY AND MAY NOT DO

A quiet coach is often a coach following a rule. This chapter says what each level allows, and when. Every date is for the class of 2029, worked out from the rule next to it.

WHEN EACH LEVEL MAY REACH HIM

LEVEL	CALLS, EMAIL AND TEXTS	MEETING HIM IN PERSON, OFF CAMPUS	WHERE IT IS PRINTED
DIVISION I	Not before 1 August of junior year. The coach may not take his call before then either.	Not before 1 September of junior year.	Bylaws 13.1.3.1.1, 13.1.3.2.3, 13.4.1.1 and 13.1.1.1.1
DIVISION II	At any time.	From 15 June before junior year.	Division II Bylaws 13.1.3.1 and 13.1.1.1
DIVISION III	No limit on timing.	Once he has finished his sophomore year.	Division III Bylaws 13.02.10.1 and 13.1.1.1
NAIA	All year, with no limit on how often or by what means.	No recruiting calendar.	The NAIA recruiting page
JUNIOR COLLEGE	See Chapter 11.	Staff may visit him "at any location."	NJCAA Bylaws, Section 4, C.1

For the class of 2029 the three dates are 15 June 2027, 1 August 2027 and 1 September 2027. All three are PROJECTED. This book worked them out from the rule, and the NCAA has not printed them.

DIVISION I: THE FINE PRINT THAT MATTERS

- **His call does not get around the rule.** Before 1 August 2027 a Division I coach may not call him. The coach also may not take a call from him or from you. That is Bylaw 13.1.3.2.3.
- **Email, texts and mail wait for the same day.** Bylaw 13.4.1.1 says a school may not send recruiting materials or electronic messages before then.
- **A school gets seven recruiting chances with him a year.** A chance is a contact or an evaluation. From 1 September of junior year, no more than three off-campus contacts may be among the seven. A meeting with you counts the same as a meeting with him. That is Bylaw 13.1.5.2, revised 15 April 2026.
- **Summer looks are not counted.** Watching him from 1 September to 31 May uses a chance. Watching him from 1 June to 31 August does not. A contact uses a chance in any month. A talk during a campus visit does not. That is Bylaw 13.1.5.11.
- **No calls during the college's own game.** Staff may not call from the time their team reports until it is let go. That is Bylaw 13.1.3.2.1.

FOUR KINDS OF WEEK ON THE DIVISION I BASEBALL CALENDAR

LABEL	WHAT THE STAFF MAY DO IN PERSON	CALLS AND MESSAGES
CONTACT PERIOD	Meet and watch players off campus.	Allowed
QUIET PERIOD	Meet players only on the college's own campus. No meeting or watching off campus.	Allowed
DEAD PERIOD	Nothing in person, on campus or off. No official or unofficial visits.	Allowed
RECRUITING SHUTDOWN	Nothing at all. No contacts, no watching and no visits.	Not allowed. No mail, and no calls made or taken.

These are the labels printed on the 2026-27 Division I baseball calendar, updated 30 July 2026. It has no week called an "evaluation period." A dead period and a shutdown are not the same thing. Messages go on in the first and stop in the second. "Allowed" still means allowed for his age, so nothing before 1 August of junior year.

VISITS, BY LEVEL

LEVEL	FIRST PAID VISIT	WHAT THE COLLEGE MAY PAY FOR	UNOFFICIAL VISITS
DIVISION I	1 September of junior year. One paid visit per school before 15 October after he graduates. Bylaws 13.6.2.1.2 and 13.6.2.2.	His travel. No more than two nights in a row of lodging. Meals, lodging and fun for him and up to four family members, within 30 miles of campus. Up to five free tickets to a home event.	None with the baseball staff before 1 September of junior year. After that, no limit, at your cost. Up to three free tickets. Bylaws 13.7.1.2, 13.7.2 and 13.7.3.1.
DIVISION II	15 June before junior year. One per school, for no more than 48 hours. A transcript comes first. Bylaws 13.3.1.2, 13.3.1.1, 13.3.3 and 13.3.2.1(a).	Ask the school.	No limit, at your cost. Free tickets to a home event are allowed. Bylaws 13.4.1 and 13.4.2.1.1.
DIVISION III	January 1 of junior year. One per school, for no more than 48 hours. Bylaws 13.6.1.1.1, 13.6.1.1 and 13.6.2.	Ask the school.	No limit, and allowed before January of junior year. Bylaw 13.7.1.
NAIA	No start date in the pages read.	Travel, meals or lodging, but only if the college does the same for other students with special talents. For example, the same treatment a fine arts student or a science student would get.	Ask the school.
JUNIOR COLLEGE	1 June before junior year. One per college each recruiting year, for no more than 48 hours.	Round-trip travel, meals, lodging and local fun for him and two guests. Game tickets only as the public gets them.	Up to two that include playing with the team. No limit on visits without that.

Division I allows no visit of any kind in a dead period or a shutdown. Division II allows none in the dead period before its signing date. The Division III Manual 2026-27 prints no dead or quiet periods at all. The NAIA rows come from the NAIA Handbook 2025-2026, Article II, Sections C and D. The junior college rows come from NJCAA Bylaws, Section 4, B.1 and B.2.

CAMPS AND TRYOUTS

- **A Division I school's own camp.** A coach may not have a recruiting talk with a camper before 1 September of the camper's junior year. That is Bylaw 13.12.1.5.2, in effect from 1 August 2026.
- **A Division I coach at a private camp.** In a quiet period he may not work one. Outside a quiet period he may, if the camp is open to any and all players and was advertised at least 14 days ahead. Those are Bylaws 13.12.1.2.1 and 13.12.2.2.2.
- **A Division II tryout.** A school may hold one tryout with him, from 15 June before junior year. It must be on campus or at the team's normal practice site. That is Bylaw 13.8.2.1.
- **An NAIA tryout.** Two NAIA sources do not match. The NAIA Official Handbook 2026-2027 and the recruiting page say two days of tryouts at each NAIA school. The parents page and the student guide say "a maximum of two days of tryouts throughout their entire athletic career." Both were read on 11 November 2026. Ask the school which one it follows.
- **An NAIA coach at his game.** The coach may come to watch a game or a practice. He may not ask your son to show a skill, or run the workout. That is the NAIA Handbook 2025-2026, page 50.
- **A Division III coach at his game.** On a game day his own high school or club coach lets him go first. Only then may a Division III college coach speak to him. That is Division III Bylaw 13.1.3.1.

FOUR LINES TO CHECK AGAINST A RULE

- "**Have him call me.**" A Division I coach may not take that call before 1 August of junior year.
- "**Stop by and meet the staff.**" Not at a Division I school before 1 September of junior year.
- "**Come to camp so we can talk.**" A Division I camp may teach him. It may not recruit him before that same day.
- "**We have 11.7.**" Ask if the school opted in. If it did, the number is 34 roster spots.

5. CLUB, CAMPS, AND WHERE HE IS SEEN

A coach can only recruit a player he is allowed to watch. So this chapter starts with where the rules let a coach be. Then it shows you how to build your own list of schools.

WHAT THIS BOOK WILL NOT TELL YOU

In this book, "club" means any team that is not his school team. That can be a travel team, a summer team or a fall team. This book has no count of where college players were first seen. No source it read splits school ball from club ball. So it will not say that one matters more than the other. It will say what the rules allow, and that part is firm.

WHERE A DIVISION I COACH MAY BE THIS YEAR

DATES, 2026-27	LABEL	WHAT IT MEANS FOR WATCHING HIM
1 TO 16 AUG 2026	Contact period	Staff may watch and meet players off campus.
17 AUG TO 10 SEP 2026	Quiet period	No watching off campus.
11 SEP TO 11 OCT 2026	Contact period	The one fall month when staff may watch off campus.
12 OCT 2026 TO 28 FEB 2027	Quiet period	No watching off campus, all winter.
1 MAR TO 31 JUL 2027	Contact period	Open, but for three dead periods: 31 May to 7 June 2027, 19 to 21 June 2027, and 3 to 5 July 2027.

Source: Division I Baseball 2026-27 NCAA Recruiting Calendar, updated 30 July 2026, read 11 November 2026. It is the only year printed. The dead periods and shutdowns inside the winter quiet period are in Chapter 3.

Read it by season. Fall has one open month. Winter is closed. Spring and summer are open from 1 March to 31 July. His school season runs on dates your state association sets, so lay those dates over this table.

Summer has one more edge. A Division I school gets seven recruiting chances with a player each year. A look at him from 1 June to 31 August does not use one up. So a staff can watch him all summer and keep its seven for the school year.

CAMPS, SHOWCASES AND TRYOUTS

A showcase is a paid event where players work out in front of people who grade them. Chapter 4 has the rules on what a camp or a showcase can do for him.

- **A Division I school's own camp can teach him.** It cannot recruit him before 1 September of junior year.
- **A winter showcase needs a second look.** From 12 October 2026 to 28 February 2027, Division I staff may not watch off campus. They may work only their own camp, on their own campus or regular field.
- **A private camp in the open months must be open to all.** A Division I coach may work it only if any player may sign up and it was advertised 14 days ahead.
- **Division II may try him out.** One tryout per school, from 15 June before junior year.
- **NAIA may try him out and may watch his games.** NAIA has no recruiting calendar.
- **A junior college may bring him in to play.** He may make up to two unofficial visits that include playing with the team.

HOW MANY PROGRAMS THERE ARE

LEVEL	PROGRAMS	HOW IT WAS COUNTED, AND WHEN
DIVISION I	309	The NCAA table "2026-27 NCAA Projected Sport Sponsorship: As of September 2026." Its data closed on 29 July 2026. Read 11 November 2026. The three add up to 940.
DIVISION II	251	
DIVISION III	380	
NAIA	No official count	SERVICE: two commercial lists print 196 and 183. They do not match. Read 11 November 2026.
JUNIOR COLLEGE	397	The header of the NJCAA teams page for 2026-27. It shows 191 teams in NJCAA Division I and 189 in NJCAA Division II. Read 11 November 2026 from a search result, not the full page. That leaves only 17 teams for NJCAA Division III, which looks too low. Treat 397 as unsettled.

Division III is the largest NCAA group. The NAIA and junior college rows are softer than the NCAA rows, and Chapter 11 says why.

BUILD YOUR OWN LIST

1. Write five headings: Division I, Division II, Division III, NAIA and junior college. Put schools under every one.
2. Open each team's own roster page. Count the players. Count the players at his position. Count the seniors at his position.
3. Write down the date you counted. Rosters change.
4. For each Division I school, add one more box: opted in, yes or no. Ask the staff.
5. A roster page may show more than 34. Some older players do not count toward the limit. Ask the staff how many count. That is Bylaw 17.2.2.2.
6. For each junior college, add its NJCAA division. That sets what it may pay.
7. Cross off any school he would not attend if baseball ended.

A counted program sample for this sport is coming in the next edition.

ASK BEFORE YOU PAY FOR ANY EVENT

- Which college staffs have said in writing that they will be there?
- Is the date in a contact period, a quiet period, a dead period or a shutdown?
- May those coaches talk recruiting with a player his age yet?

6. WHAT TO SEND, AND WHAT GOOD VIDEO LOOKS LIKE

One email, from him, with two links. It is short. Every number in it says how it was measured, and when.

SUBJECT LINE, 76 CHARACTERS, NOT COUNTING SPACES

2029 right-handed pitcher, Anytown South HS · 6'1" · fastball 84-86 · 3.5 GPA · video inside

BODY, ABOUT 175 WORDS, FROM HIS OWN MAILBOX

Coach Tolliver,

My name is Diego Whitlock. I am a right-handed pitcher and third baseman at Anytown South HS. I graduate in 2029.

Measured on 31 July 2027 by my school coach, with a radar gun and a tape:
Height 6'1" in socks. Weight 185 pounds.
Fastball 84 to 86 mph over 20 pitches. Best pitch 87.
60 yards in 7.1 seconds, timed by hand.

School season, spring 2027, 22 games: 41 innings, 52 strikeouts, 14 walks. As a hitter: 71 at-bats, 24 hits.

Unweighted GPA 3.5 on a 4-point scale. NCAA ID 2900000000. I want to study engineering.

My summer team is the Anytown Aces, for players 16 and under. The full schedule, with fields and game times, is in the second link.

I have two questions. How many pitchers will you add in the 2029 class? And what time zone are you in? I would like to call you this month at a time that suits you.

Video, no login: example.com/diego-video
Schedule: example.com/diego-schedule

Thank you for your time.

Diego Whitlock
player@example.com
(555) 555-0142

Invented player, invented school, invented team, invented coach, invented numbers. The numbers are not a target. No rule book this book read sets one. The links are placeholders. GPA means Grade Point Average.

WHY IT IS WRITTEN THIS WAY

- **He writes it.** The rules in Chapter 4 are about a coach and a player. The coach is recruiting him, not you.
- **Class year comes first.** Every date in Chapter 4 hangs on his class year. It tells a coach what he may do today.
- **Each stat has the count behind it.** "52 strikeouts" alone means little. "52 strikeouts in 41 innings over 22 games" can be weighed.
- **The schedule gets its own link.** A Division I staff may watch off campus only in a contact period. Dates and fields let a staff plan a trip.
- **One question is about the roster.** At an opted-in Division I school the real limit is 34 players. So he asks how many the staff will add.
- **He asks for a time zone, not a town.** From 1 August of junior year a Division I coach may take his call. A time zone sets that call up.
- **No attachments, and no login.** A link that opens with no sign-in can be opened by anyone on the staff.

WHEN TO SEND IT

LEVEL	WHEN A COACH MAY ANSWER
DIVISION I	From 1 August 2027, PROJECTED from the rule. Send it that morning.
DIVISION II AND III	At any time. He can send it today.
NAIA	All year. He can send it today.
JUNIOR COLLEGE	Ask the coach. Chapter 11 says what this book could not find.

Change two lines for each coach: the name, and the question. After the first email, send three kinds of news. Send his schedule before each event. Send his grades each term. Send any new number, with the tool and the date.

LABEL EVERY NUMBER

No bylaw this book read sets a pitch speed, a ball speed off the bat, a height or a 60-yard time for any division. So there is no official bar to clear, and no chart is a rule. A number is worth only what someone else can check. Write the tool, the date, who measured, and how many tries he took. Give a range over many pitches, not just the best one.

WHAT GOOD VIDEO LOOKS LIKE

No rule book sets a video standard. This edition has no coach on the record about baseball video. So what follows is this book's own checklist, and it is not a rule. It rests on one idea: show the whole play, so nobody has to trust you.

- The first screen shows his name, class year, position, school and the date filmed.
- The camera sits on a stand and stays still. His whole body is in the frame.
- Game clips come first. Any practice clip is marked as practice.
- Each clip runs from before the pitch until the play ends, with no cut in the middle.
- A pitcher shows full pitches, with the catcher in the frame.
- A hitter shows the swing and where the ball lands.
- A fielder shows the catch, the throw and the ball reaching the base.
- If the email claims a speed, the clip shows the radar reading.
- There is no music. Slow motion comes only after the same clip at full speed.
- The link needs no login. Open it on a signed-out phone before he sends it.
- A full game sits ready in case a coach asks for one.

7. WHAT THE PAPERWORK REALLY MEANS

Three kinds of paper decide whether he plays: an account, a list of classes, and a signed offer. Each level uses its own paper. None of it is hard, and all of it has a date.

THE NCAA ELIGIBILITY CENTER ACCOUNT

The Center has three kinds of account. The first is the Academic and Athletics Certification account, for Division I or Division II. The second is the Athletics Certification account. The third is the Profile Page account, and it is free. The NCAA's own register page lists all three.

WHERE THE FEE IS PRINTED	THE FEE	WHEN THIS BOOK READ IT
The Center's live registration page	$120 for a student in this country. $180 for a student from abroad.	11 November 2026
The NCAA Registration Checklist	$110 for a student in this country. $170 for a student from abroad.	11 November 2026, as a search result. It says "Effective September 1" and shows no year.

The Center's own page wins. Two NCAA sources print two fees. Pay what the live registration page shows on the day he registers.

- **The Center waits for a school.** Its page says, "We will not begin your certification until it is requested by an NCAA school." The athletics request opens "during your senior year of high school."
- **A paid Division I visit needs it.** Before the visit he must register with the Center and send the school a transcript. He must also be on that school's request list. That is Bylaw 13.6.3.
- **The last step is a final certification.** He must have it "before engaging in practice or competition." Without it he may practice for up to 45 days, and he may not play in games. Those are Bylaws 12.1.1.1.3 and 12.1.1.1.3.1, in effect from 1 August 2026.

THE CLASSES: 16 CORE COURSES

LEVEL	WHAT THE RULE ASKS FOR	WHERE IT IS PRINTED
DIVISION I	16 core courses. He must finish 10 of them before his seventh semester of high school starts. Seven of those 10 must be English, math, or natural or physical science. He also needs a Grade Point Average of at least 2.300 in his core courses.	Bylaws 14.3.1.1(a) and 14.3.1.1(b), Division I Manual 2026-27
DIVISION II	16 core-course units. A Grade Point Average of at least 2.200 in those courses. Proof that he graduated.	Bylaw 14, Division II Manual 2026-27
NAIA	He must register with the NAIA Eligibility Center. To compete he must be enrolled in at least 12 hours each term.	Two NAIA pages for students and parents

The seventh semester is the first half of 12th grade. So the 10 are counted before senior year starts, and those 10 grades are then locked. Ask his counselor which of his classes the NCAA counts. Division I asks for a core-course Grade Point Average of at least 2.300. That is Bylaw 14.3.1.1(a).

THE SIGNED OFFER

There is no National Letter of Intent. The Division I Council ended that program on 9 October 2024. The Division I manual now prints signing dates for an "Athletics Aid Agreement." In plain words, it is a written offer of athletics aid. At an opted-in school he may also get a second paper, a settlement related benefits agreement, and the same first day applies.

Baseball has one opening day. The rule is the second Wednesday in November, in Bylaw 13.02.13.1(f). Division II uses the same Wednesday, in its Bylaw 13.02.10.1(c). Baseball has no early period and no regular period. For 2026-27 the NCAA printed the day as 11 November 2026. For the class of 2029 the day is PROJECTED as Wednesday 8 November 2028. This book worked that out from the rule, and the NCAA has not printed it. The NCAA says the last day to sign is "based on institutional policy," so each school sets its own.

LEVEL	WHAT HE SIGNS	FIRST DAY, CLASS OF 2029
DIVISION I	An athletics aid agreement.	PROJECTED Wednesday 8 November 2028, from Bylaw 13.02.13.1(f).
DIVISION II	An athletics aid agreement.	PROJECTED Wednesday 8 November 2028, from Division II Bylaw 13.02.10.1(c).
DIVISION III	Nothing. There is no aid agreement and no signing date.	None.
NAIA	A letter with one NAIA school, if that school uses one. The NAIA says it "does not have a letter of intent program."	No date set by the NAIA.
JUNIOR COLLEGE	The NJCAA Letter of Intent. It lasts one school year at most, from 1 August to 31 July.	PROJECTED 1 November 2028, from the NJCAA chart for 2026-27. No scholarship agreement "of any type" may come before the chart's date.

A player who graduates at midyear, and will enroll at midyear, may sign from the first day too. That is Bylaw 13.02.13.1.1.

A JUNIOR COLLEGE YEAR AND THE CLOCK

The NCAA gives a player a five-year clock. The clock starts at the earlier of two things. One is the first time he enrolls full time at any college, and the NCAA says that includes a two-year college. The other is the school year after his 19th birthday. The rule covers students who first enroll in fall 2027 or later, so it covers him. So a junior college year uses NCAA clock time. This rule was read for the volleyball edition of this book and carried forward.

BEFORE HE SIGNS, GET FIVE ANSWERS IN WRITING

1. How much athletics aid is it, and which costs does it cover?
2. Did the school opt in to the new Division I rules?
3. Will he be on the roster the school turns in by 1 December?
4. What is the school's last day to sign?
5. Who has to sign it: him alone, or a parent too? Chapter 11 says why this book cannot answer that.

8. WHAT IT COSTS, AND WHAT IS WASTED

This sport has two kinds of price. A fee is set by a body that makes the rules, and it is the same for every family. A SERVICE price is set by a seller, and it can change. This chapter keeps the two apart.

WHAT FAMILIES SPEND, FROM ONE NATIONAL SURVEY

WHAT THE SURVEY FOUND	NUMBER
Average spent on a child's main sport in 2024	$1,016
Change in that average since 2019	Up 46 percent
Average spent on the same child's other sports	$475
Range of answers	From nothing to almost $25,000
Rise in baseball spending over five years	68 percent

Source: the Aspen Institute's Project Play survey of 1,848 youth sports parents, taken in November and December 2024, for children ages 6 to 18. Read 11 November 2026.

The survey calls baseball "the most expensive in 2024 among the three most-played sports." Baseball parents spent more than soccer or basketball parents on four things. The four were sign-up fees, travel and hotels, lessons, and camps. The survey covers every age from 6 to 18. It is not a budget for a recruit. This book found no official figure for what a recruit costs a family.

FEES A RULE BODY SETS

FEE	AMOUNT	WHERE IT IS PRINTED, AND WHEN IT WAS READ
NCAA Eligibility Center, the account for Division I or Division II	$120 in this country, $180 from abroad	The Center's live registration page, 11 November 2026
The same account, in an older paper	$110 in this country, $170 from abroad	The NCAA Registration Checklist, 11 November 2026, as a search result
NCAA Profile Page account	Free	The NCAA's register page, 11 November 2026

The Center's own page wins. Chapter 7 says why two figures are in print.

SERVICE PRICES: CAMPS, EVENTS AND STREAMING

This book found prices for camps, team events and game streaming. Each one is a SERVICE price, set by the seller. Each one was read from a search result and not from the seller's full page. So this chapter does not print them as settled. They sit in Chapter 11, each with its SERVICE label and the day it was read. This book names no seller, so ask a seller for its own current price before you budget.

PRICE HIS OWN YEAR

LINE	ASK THE SELLER	YOUR NUMBER
CLUB TEAM FEE	What does the fee leave out?	$
TEAM EVENTS	Is the entry fee inside the team fee? Is there a fee at the gate?	$
TRAVEL AND HOTELS	How many trips, and how far?	$
LESSONS	How many a month, and for which months?	$
CAMPS	Which coaches work it, and may they talk recruiting with him yet?	$
SHOWCASES	What does he get in writing when it ends?	$
VIDEO	Can a parent film it with a phone and a stand?	$
ELIGIBILITY CENTER	Free for the Profile Page. See the fee table above for the paid account.	$

WHAT IS WASTED

- **A Division I camp bought to start a talk.** Before 1 September of junior year the coach may not talk recruiting with him at that camp. Pay for it if he wants the teaching. Do not pay for it to be recruited.
- **A winter event sold on Division I coaches.** From 12 October 2026 to 28 February 2027 those coaches may not watch off campus.
- **A summer event on a dead day.** No Division I coach may watch in person from 31 May to 7 June 2027, 19 to 21 June 2027, or 3 to 5 July 2027.
- **A trip to meet a Division I staff too early.** An unofficial visit with the baseball staff is not allowed before 1 September of junior year.
- **The paid Center account, bought years ahead.** The Profile Page is free. The Center will not start his file until an NCAA school asks.
- **Any plan built on 11.7.** That number is superseded. Chapter 2 has the one in force.
- **A chart of speeds by position.** No bylaw this book read sets one. A chart from a seller is a SERVICE number.

WHAT IS FREE

- Every rule and date in this book, at the pages listed in Chapter 11.
- The NCAA Profile Page account.
- An email. Division II, Division III and NAIA coaches may answer it at any time.
- A paid visit, when a college offers one. Chapter 4 lists what each level may cover.

FIVE QUESTIONS BEFORE ANY CHECK IS WRITTEN

1. What is the full price, with every add-on?
2. Which college staffs have said in writing that they will be there?
3. Is the date in a contact period on the Division I calendar?
4. May those coaches talk recruiting with a player his age?
5. What will he hold in his hand when it is over?

9. CHECKLIST BY GRADE

One row per year, in order. Cross items off. If a year slips, the fix is most often more schools and one more month, not more money.

YEAR	DO THIS
9TH GRADE DONE	Play, and keep every grade. Ask his counselor which of his classes the NCAA counts as core courses. Spend nothing on recruiting.
10TH GRADE THIS YEAR	Read Chapter 2 before you pay for anything. Build the list in Chapter 5, with all five levels on it. Open the free NCAA Profile Page account. Film his games from a stand. Measure him, and write down the tool, the date and who measured. Send the Chapter 6 email to Division II, Division III and NAIA coaches, who may answer at any time. Do not have him phone a Division I coach. Do not buy a Division I camp to be recruited.
SUMMER AFTER 10TH GRADE	From 1 June 2027 a junior college may pay for a visit. From 15 June 2027 a Division II coach may meet him, pay for a visit and try him out. Once 10th grade ends, a Division III coach may meet him off campus. On 1 August 2027 send the email to Division I coaches and ask for a call time. All four dates are PROJECTED from the rules in Chapter 3.
11TH GRADE	From 1 September 2027 a Division I coach may meet him and host a visit. Before a paid Division I visit, send a transcript, register with the Eligibility Center, and get on the school's request list. From 1 January 2028 a Division III school may pay for a visit. Both dates are PROJECTED. Send his grades each term and his schedule before each event. In spring, count his core courses with his counselor. Ten must be done before 12th grade. Look up the 2027-28 Division I calendar when it is printed.
SUMMER AFTER 11TH GRADE	Send one update with new video and new numbers. Ask each staff the Chapter 2 questions: did you opt in, and how many players will you add? Ask what the offer is, in writing. Look up the 2028-29 Division I calendar when it is printed.
12TH GRADE, FALL	Ask each recruiting school to request his file at the Eligibility Center. From 1 November 2028 he could sign a junior college letter, if the chart keeps its date. From Wednesday 8 November 2028 he may sign a written offer of athletics aid. Both dates are PROJECTED. Get the five answers in Chapter 7 before he signs.
AFTER SIGNING	Finish all 16 core courses and graduate. Make sure the Center has what it needs for his final certification. Without it he may practice for up to 45 days and may not play. At an opted-in Division I school, ask again whether he is on the roster due by 1 December.

THREE THINGS TO KEEP ON ONE PAGE

Keep the roster question, the dates and his schedule on one page. The roster question is in Chapter 2. The dates are in Chapter 3. The schedule is his own, with fields and times, sent before each event. Each paid item in Chapter 8 comes after those three.

10. TEN WAYS FAMILIES GET BASEBALL WRONG

1. **They count 11.7 scholarships.** That is the 2024-25 rule, and it is superseded. The current manual prints a roster limit of 34, with no NCAA limit on aid, at a school that opted in.
2. **They hear "no limit" and think it means a full scholarship.** Schools "have the option" to give aid to all 34. An option is not a promise, and aid of any size uses a whole spot.
3. **They have him phone a Division I coach in 10th grade.** The coach may not take that call before 1 August of junior year.
4. **They drive to a Division I campus to meet the staff early.** An unofficial visit with the baseball staff is not allowed before 1 September of junior year.
5. **They buy a Division I camp to start the talk.** The camp may teach him. The coach may not talk recruiting with him there before 1 September of junior year.
6. **They think Division II must wait for 15 June.** A Division II coach may call or write at any time. The 15 June date is for meeting in person, paid visits and tryouts.
7. **They treat every quiet week the same.** In a dead period a coach may still call and write. In a recruiting shutdown he may do nothing at all. And this year's dates are for this year only.
8. **They wait for a National Letter of Intent.** Division I ended it in October 2024. The paper is a written offer of athletics aid. It has one opening day, the second Wednesday in November.
9. **They skip three of the five levels.** Division III has 380 programs, more than Division I or Division II. NAIA puts a ceiling of 12 on a team's school aid, and no limit on its roster. A junior college team may sign 30. The 2026 draft took 12 players from junior colleges. But a junior college year uses NCAA clock time, so pick it on purpose.
10. **They plan for the draft and not for school.** Teams drafted 127 high school seniors in 2026. The same draft took 474 players from four-year colleges. In one draft year, about 1 in 3,700 high school players is picked. Count seniors only and it is about 1 in 930. Both are this book's rough arithmetic.

11. SOURCES, AND WHAT WE COULD NOT SETTLE

Every rule, number and date in this book came from one of the documents below, read on 11 November 2026. Where two official pages disagree, both figures are printed in the chapter that uses them.

NCAA Division I Manual 2026-27, 412 pages, page footer dated 11 November 2026. Used for the baseball call, message, contact, visit and camp dates in Bylaw 13. Used for the seven recruiting chances in Bylaws 13.1.5.2 and 13.1.5.11, and the roster limit of 34 in Bylaws 17.2 and 17.2.2.2. Used for the core-course rules in Bylaws 14.3.1.1(a) and 14.3.1.1(b), the final certification in Bylaw 12.1.1.1.3, and the signing date in Bylaw 13.02.13. web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

NCAA Division I Manual 2024-25, Bylaws 15.5.4 and 15.5.4.1, for the superseded rule of 11.7 scholarships, 27 counters and a 25 percent floor. Read from a saved copy. The download address was not recorded.

NCAA Division II Manual 2026-27, 318 pages, page footer dated 11 November 2026. Used for the "at any time" rule, the 15 June dates, tryouts, the 9.0 limit, the cap of 60 awards, the 16 core-course units and the signing date. web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90010

NCAA Division III Manual 2026-27, 254 pages. Used for the rule against athletics aid, the open timing of messages, off-campus contact after sophomore year, and paid visits from January 1 of junior year. It prints no dead or quiet periods. web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90011

Division I Baseball 2026-27 NCAA Recruiting Calendar, marked "Updated: July 30, 2026." Used for every contact, quiet, dead and shutdown date and for the four labels. The dates were checked against the color grid on 11 November 2026. The calendar is a one-year document, and no later year is printed. ncaaorg.s3.amazonaws.com/compliance/recruiting/calendar/2026-27/2026-27D1Rec_MBARecruitingCalendar.pdf

NCAA recruiting page, for the 2026-27 signing date of 11 November 2026 and the line that the last day is "based on institutional policy." ncaa.org/eligibility-center/recruiting

College Sports Commission, roster limits page, for the table line "Baseball (M): Old Scholarship Limit 11.7, New Roster Limit 34, Potential Increase in Scholarships 22.3." collegesportscommission.org/roster-limits

NCAA settlement questions and answers, updated 29 May 2026, for the rules at Division I schools that did not opt in: aid of any size to any number of players, and the settlement rules once a school gives more than 11.7. First read for the volleyball edition of this book, then checked again on 11 November 2026. ncaaorg.s3.amazonaws.com/governance/d1/legislation/May2026D1Gov_PhaseEightSetQuestionandAnswer.pdf

NCAA Division II athletics scholarships page, for the meaning of an equivalency limit. ncaa.org/division-ii/governance/membership-and-institutional-resources/athletics-scholarships

NCAA Eligibility Center, for the three kinds of account and the live fee of $120 and $180. ncaa.org/eligibility-center/register and web3.ncaa.org/ecwr3/register/CERTIFICATION

NCAA Registration Checklist, for the fee of $110 and $170. Read as a search result, not as the full file. fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/Registration_Checklist.pdf

NCAA projected sport sponsorship for 2026-27, as of September 2026, for 309, 251 and 380 programs. ncaa.org/about-us/membership-directory/membership-composition-and-sport-sponsorship

NCAA Research, the table of odds of playing past high school, last updated March 2026, for 472,598 and 41,580 players, the four shares, and the 2025 draft counts. ncaaorg.s3.amazonaws.com/research/pro_beyond/RES_ProbabilityBeyondHSFiguresMethod.pdf

Major League Baseball release of 13 July 2026, for 613 players picked in 20 rounds. The count of 127 high school seniors, 474 four-year college players and 12 players from junior colleges was made for this book from the league's own draft data. statsapi.mlb.com/api/v1/draft/2026

NCAA page on the age-based rules for Division I and Division II, for the five-year clock. Read for the volleyball edition of this book and carried forward. ncaa.org/eligibility-center/division-i-and-division-ii-age-based-eligibility-rules

NAIA Official Handbook 2026-2027, 41st edition, August 2026. Used for the aid ceiling of 12 on printed page 123, which is page 124 of the PDF file. Used for the line on printed page 121 that sets no roster limit, and for the tryout rule in Article II, Section C, item 2. naia.org/wp-content/uploads/2026-07-2026_Official_Handbook.pdf

NAIA Handbook 2025-2026, for the rule on paid visits in Article II, Section C, item 3, and for coach observation on page 50. These two were read in last year's edition and were not read again in the new one.

NAIA financial aid page, for the line that NAIA limits are full awards a school may divide. Read for the volleyball edition of this book and carried forward. The page would not open on 11 November 2026. naia.org/why-naia/naia-financial-aid

Three NAIA pages, for year-round contact, the two tryout wordings, the letter of intent line and the 12 hours each term. naia.org/why-naia/recruiting and naia.org/student-athletes/prospective/parents and naia.org/student-athletes/prospective/high-school-students

NJCAA Bylaws for 2026-27, file dated 27 October 2026, for visits on pages 52 and 53, aid by division on page 44, and the letter of intent on pages 48 and 49. A newer file dated 5 November 2026 is posted and was not read. njcaa.org/compliance

NJCAA Sports Procedures Chart for 2026-27, for 30 signees and the 1 November date. The chart says it is tentative. The chart is reissued during the year, so check the association's own page for the newest file. njcaa.org/compliance

NJCAA teams pages, for 397, 191 and 189 teams. Read as search results. njcaa.org/sports/bsb/teams

Aspen Institute Project Play, the family spending survey, for $1,016, $475, 46 percent and 68 percent. projectplay.org/news/2025/2/24/project-play-survey-family-spending-on-youth-sports-rises-46-over-five-years

SERVICE: two commercial lists of NAIA baseball colleges, for 196 and 183. Two recruiting services' own pages, read 11 November 2026.

SERVICE PRICES THIS BOOK FOUND AND COULD NOT SETTLE

Each price below is a SERVICE price, set by the seller. Each one comes from the seller's own page, as read on 11 November 2026. All four rows were read from a search summary of that page, and not from the full page. They are used here as examples of a price. They are not a shortlist of where to go.

WHAT IT IS	SERVICE PRICE	WHERE IT WAS READ
One Division I school's summer showcase camp	$250. A data package and a speed and power session are $100 each.	The seller's own page, read 11 November 2026.
Five one-day prospect camps listed for 14 November 2026	$100 to $195	The seller's own page, read 11 November 2026.
One summer team event	$495 a team for ages 14 and under. $695 a team for the 16 and 18 age groups. A $125 skills camp. A $10 daily gate fee.	The seller's own page, read 11 November 2026.
One event company's game streaming plan	$15.99 a month, or $191.88 a year	The seller's own page, read 11 November 2026.

The six camp prices run from $100 to $250 for one day, before add-ons. That is six listings, not a survey.

WHAT WE COULD NOT SETTLE

Each item below is UNCONFIRMED. This book has no document that settles it.

- **His own Division I calendars.** The 2027-28 and 2028-29 baseball calendars are not printed. Every period date in this book is for 2026-27 only.
- **His own signing date.** The 2028-29 signing sheet does not exist yet. Wednesday 8 November 2028 is arithmetic from the second-Wednesday rule, and it can move.
- **Which Division I schools opted in.** This book found no list. Ask each school.
- **Any plan to change the 34.** None was found, and none was searched for.
- **Watching a 10th grader.** This book did not read whether a Division I coach may watch a sophomore in person in a contact period. It read only the junior-year dates.
- **Direct messages on social media.** The manual says "electronic correspondence." The rule that names direct messages was not found.
- **Older wording.** Bylaws 13.1.1.1.1, 13.6.2.1.2 and 13.7.1.2 were all revised on 24 June 2026. Pages written before then may show another baseball date.
- **Division I visit limits.** The total number of paid visits across all schools was not found. Nor was the rule on paying for family travel.
- **Division II tickets.** The count of free tickets on a Division II visit was not printed in the part read.
- **Roster limits in Division II and Division III.** None was read. One other source says Division II has no national limit.
- **Junior college contact.** The recruiting section prints no start date for calls or texts. The rest of the bylaws were not read, so "no rule" is not proven. Region rules were not collected.

- **Junior college counts.** The NJCAA Division III page could not be read. Two-year colleges outside the NJCAA are not in the 397. The 397 itself came from a search result. Its split leaves only 17 teams for NJCAA Division III, which looks too low.
- **The junior college number 24.** It is often repeated. The 2026-27 chart prints 30, and no page printing 24 was captured.
- **NAIA counts and aid.** No official count of NAIA baseball programs was found. The Handbook lists some aid that may sit outside the 12, and that part was not read in full. Its table prints no unit for the 12. The unit in Chapter 2 comes from the NAIA's own aid page.
- **NAIA tryouts.** The NAIA's own pages disagree: two days at each school, or two days in a whole career.
- **The NAIA Eligibility Center fee.** A search result of the NAIA student guide prints $110 for a high school student in this country or Canada, and $170 from abroad. The full guide was not opened.
- **The NCAA fee.** The live page says $120 and $180. The checklist says $110 and $170, with no year. The checklist also prints $75 for the Athletics Certification account.
- **Who signs.** This book did not read who must sign an aid agreement.
- **Amateur rules.** Bylaw 12 was revised on 24 June 2026. The rules on advisers, pro tryouts and pay for name and image were not read.
- **The draft.** This book did not count how many of the 127 high school picks signed. It did not read the rules on who may be drafted. It did not read which teams get the six extra rounds, or why.
- **Size and speed by position.** No official standard was found. Commercial tables were not collected.
- **Other paths.** The summer draft league and the independent pro leagues were read only as search results. So this book does not describe them.
- **What a recruit costs.** No rule body prints a typical family spend for a baseball recruit. The survey in Chapter 8 covers every age from 6 to 18.

Made by The Commit Book. Education, not legal advice. No result, no playing time, no acceptance, and no money is promised. Rule text, calendars and pages checked 11 November 2026. The player, school, team and coach in the sample email are invented.